

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ  
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

## Lisan ul Quran — Lecture Supplement

The Murakkab 'Atfi · its rules and elements

### 1. Where the Murakkab 'Atfi stands among the constructions

A group of two or more words is called a *Murakkab*. The *Murakkab* is of two great kinds.

| Kind           | Definition                                                                  | What it includes                             |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Murakkab Tamm  | one from which a complete sense is understood                               | the Jumla Ismiyyah and the Jumla Fi'liyyah   |
| Murakkab Naqis | one from which a complete sense is not had, but something further is needed | the Tawsifi, Isharee, Jarri, Idafi and 'Atfi |

**Already covered:** The *Murakkab Tawsifi* was studied in Lectures 20 and 21, the *Murakkab Isharee* in Lecture 22, the *Murakkab Idafi* in Lecture 23, and the *Murakkab Jarri* in Lectures 27 and 28. The fifth, the *Murakkab 'Atfi*, is now before us.

### 2. The definition and the three elements

**Definition:** The words that join two or more words, constructions or clauses together are called the *Huroof ul 'Atf*, and the whole group is called a *Murakkab 'Atfi*.

| Element        | Definition                                        | In the example |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Ma'toof 'Alayh | the noun or clause coming before the Harf ul 'Atf | الشَّمْسُ      |
| Harf ul 'Atf   | the joining particle that comes between           | وَ             |
| Ma'toof        | the noun or clause coming after the Harf ul 'Atf  | القَمَرُ       |

الشَّمْسُ وَ الْقَمَرُ

(the sun and the moon)

**The basic principle:** The I'raab of the *Ma'toof* always accords with that of the *Ma'toof 'Alayh* — that is, the Ma'toof follows its Ma'toof 'Alayh.

### 3. The grammatical standing of the Huroof ul 'Atf

A *Harf* is a word that holds meaning but does not give a complete sense on its own; its meaning becomes plain when it joins a noun or a verb. All *huroof* are *Mabni*.

#### 'Amilah and Ghayr 'Amilah

| Kind                 | Definition                                                                                   |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Huroof 'Amilah       | those that act upon the noun or verb after them and bring about a change in its I'raab       |
| Huroof Ghayr 'Amilah | those that have no effect upon the noun or verb after them and bring no change to its I'raab |

**Where do the Huroof ul 'Atf belong?:** The *Huroof ul 'Atf* are *Ghayr 'Amilah*, because they do **not themselves change** the I'raab of the word after them; rather they give it the I'raab of the word before. This is their fundamental mark.

**A fine comparison:** The *Huroof ul Jarrah* give *jarr* to the noun after them, and the *Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l* give *nasb* to their noun. But the *Huroof ul 'Atf* give nothing — they only carry the I'raab of the earlier word across to the later one.

## 4. The nine Huroof ul 'Atf

The well-known *Huroof ul 'Atf* in Arabic are nine. There are deep differences among them in meaning and in rhetorical effect.

|      |      |         |
|------|------|---------|
| وَ   | فَ   | ثُمَّ   |
| أَوْ | أَمْ | لَكِنَّ |
| بَلْ | لَا  | حَتَّى  |

### 4.1 Wa — and

This particle is used when two things or two acts occur together or at once. The clauses joined by the waw are generally about one and the same matter.

مُحَمَّدٌ وَمُؤْمِنَةٌ — Muhammad and Mu'minah (both coming at one and the same time)

### 4.2 Fa — so, then

**Tarteeb ma' at-Ta'qeeb:** This comes where the second act occurs **immediately after** the first, with no delay or interval.

As when Muhammad came and a little while later Mu'minah came — there being no long interval between, **فَ** will be used.

### 4.3 Thumma — then

**Tarteeb ma' at-Taraakhi:** This carries the sense of **a considerable interval and respite**. Where an act takes place after a good while, this is used.

إِنَّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا ثُمَّ كَفَرُوا ثُمَّ آمَنُوا ثُمَّ كَفَرُوا ثُمَّ أَرَادُوا كُفْرًا لَّمْ يَكُنِ اللَّهُ لِيُغْفِرَ لَهُمْ

(Surah an-Nisa: 137)

**Translation:** Indeed those who believed, then disbelieved, then believed, then disbelieved, and then increased in disbelief — never will Allah forgive them.

**Why Thumma here?:** In this account of the hypocrites the use of **ثُمَّ** rather than **فَ** is a masterstroke of rhetoric. For believing and disbelieving take time, and they had made of it a game. Between each turn a **long period** passed, and it is that long respite which **ثُمَّ** conveys.

#### 4.4 Aw and Am — or

Both are rendered "or" in English, but their use differs plainly.

| Particle | When?                                                                            | Example                                      |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| أَوْ     | where a choice is given, or where a person expresses his own doubt or preference | I shall have vanilla or strawberry ice cream |
| أَمْ     | where a question is put and a firm determination of one of two things is sought  | do you want vanilla or chocolate?            |

**An important note on Am:** If **أَمْ** comes at the very head of a sentence it gives the sense of "or is it that"; and if it comes within the sentence, the sense of "or".

أَمْ خُلِقُوا مِنْ غَيْرِ شَيْءٍ أَمْ هُمُ الْخَالِقُونَ

(Surah at-Tur: 35)

**Translation:** Or were they created by nothing, or are they the creators?

فَفِدْيَةٌ مِّنْ صِّيَامٍ أَوْ صَدَقَةٍ أَوْ نُسْكَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 196)

**Translation:** Then a ransom of fasting or charity or sacrifice.

Here the words after **أَوْ** are the *Ma'toof*. Since the first word is under the effect of a *Harf ul Jarr*, all the others too are *Majroor*.

#### 4.5 Lakin — but

In the Qur'an this comes in two capacities: as a *Harf Mushabbah bil Fi'l* — the detail of which was given in Lecture 37 — and as a *Harf ul 'Atf*, which joins clauses while correcting what went before.

وَلَكِنْ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 12)

**Translation:** But they do not perceive.

#### 4.6 Bal — rather

This is used to join clauses, to turn back from what was said before, and to set up a new continuation in the speech.

وَلَا تَحْسَبَنَّ الَّذِينَ قُتِلُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ أَمْوَاتًا بَلْ أَحْيَاءٌ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِمْ يُرْزَقُونَ

(Surah Al 'Imran: 169)

**Translation:** And never think of those killed in the way of Allah as dead. Rather, they are alive with their Lord, receiving provision.

#### 4.7 Hatta — until

In the Qur'an this comes mostly as a *Harf ul Jarr*, that is, as '*Amilah*', as was studied in Lectures 27 and 28. But as a *Harf ul 'Atf*, that is, as *Ghayr 'Amilah*, its use is the least of all. In that case it joins clauses and keeps up the continuation.

وَإِذْ قُلْتُمْ يُمُوسَىٰ لَنْ نُؤْمِنَ لَكَ حَتَّىٰ نَرَى اللَّهَ جَهْرَةً

(Surah al-Baqarah: 55)

**Translation:** And when you said: O Musa, we will never believe you until we see Allah plainly.

#### 4.8 La — not

This is used to join with negation and to **exclude the Ma'toof** from the ruling of the *Ma'toof 'Alayh*.

## 5. The rules of agreement

The most important principle: In a *Murakkab 'Atfi* it is a binding condition that the I'raab agree between the *Ma'toof 'Alayh* and the *Ma'toof*, while agreement of gender and number is not required.

| Aspect | Agreement    | Explanation                                                                                          |
|--------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I'raab | binding      | if the Ma'toof 'Alayh is Marfoo' so is the Ma'toof; if Mansoob then Mansoob; if Majroor then Majroor |
| Wus'at | generally    | Ma'rifah and Nakirah usually match, but this does not hold the weight that I'raab does               |
| Gender | not required | السَّمْسُ is feminine and الْقَمَرُ masculine, yet they are joined by the waw                        |
| Number | not required | صَيَّامٍ is a broken plural and صَدَقَةٍ a singular, yet each is coupled to the other                |

The difference from the *Murakkab Tawsifi*: In Lectures 20 and 21 it was studied that in a *Murakkab Tawsifi* the *Sifah* and the *Mawsuf* are equal in all four aspects — gender, number, *wus'at* and I'raab. In a *Murakkab 'Atfi* only I'raab is binding. This is the basic difference between the two.

## 6. The levels of 'Atf

Rule: 'Atf is always made upon things of like rank. If a single noun stands before the *Harf ul 'Atf*, the *Ma'toof* after it will be a single noun too; if a construction stands before, the 'atf will be upon a construction; and if a whole clause stands before, the clause after will be coupled to it.

| Level                                | Example                                       | Explanation                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| single upon single                   | السَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ                         | both are standing single nouns                                                    |
| construction upon construction       | رَبُّ الْمَشْرِقَيْنِ وَرَبُّ الْمَغْرِبَيْنِ | two Murakkab Idafi joined; the I'raab of the whole was known from the first Mudaf |
| Jumla Ismiyyah upon Jumla Ismiyyah   | هَذَا حَلَالٌ وَهَذَا حَرَامٌ                 | the first clause the Ma'toof 'Alayh and the second the Ma'toof                    |
| Jumla Fi'liyyah upon Jumla Fi'liyyah | أَمِنُوا تَمَّ كَفَرُوا                       | both are clauses with verbs                                                       |

## 7. More than one Ma'toof

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One *Ma'toof 'Alayh* may have more than one *Ma'toof*, and the I'raab of them all is one and the same.

أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ يَسْجُدُ لَهُ مَنْ فِي السَّمُوتِ وَمَنْ فِي الْأَرْضِ وَالشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ وَالنُّجُومُ وَالْجِبَالُ وَالشَّجَرُ وَالْدَّوَابُّ

(Surah al-Hajj: 18)

**Translation:** Do you not see that to Allah prostrates whoever is in the heavens and whoever is on the earth, and the sun, the moon, the stars, the mountains, the trees and the moving creatures?

Here *الشَّمْسُ* is the *Ma'toof 'Alayh*, and after it the moon, the stars, the mountains, the trees and the creatures come one after another as *Ma'toof*. And the I'raab of them all is one, namely Marfoo'.

## 8. Recognising the I'raab — a practical problem

**The problem:** Both the *nasb* and the *jarr* of the *Jam' Salim Mu'annath* come with a *kasrah*, as in السَّمُوتِ. How then is one to know whether it is *Mansoob* or *Majroor*?

**The solution:** One looks at the I'raab of the other *single-noun Ma'toof* joined with it. If it reads وَالْأَرْضَ with a *fathah*, the whole construction is *Mansoob*; and if وَالْأَرْضِ with a *kasrah*, then *Majroor*.

**This is the benefit of 'Atfi:** The *Ma'toof* reveals the I'raab of its *Ma'toof 'Alayh*. So the I'raab of a doubtful word is recognised from its companion — a point of much use in reading the Qur'an.

## 9. The Murakkab 'Atfi in a Jumla Ismiyyah

A *Murakkab 'Atfi* may become either the *Mubtada* or the *Khabar* in a *Jumla Ismiyyah*.

### 9.1 As the Mubtada

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِنَّمَا الْخَمْرُ وَالْمَيْسِرُ وَالْأَنْصَابُ وَالْأَزْلَامُ رِجْسٌ مِّنْ عَمَلِ الشَّيْطَانِ

(Surah al-Ma'idah: 90)

**Translation:** O you who believe, intoxicants, gambling, idols and divining arrows are but defilement from the work of Satan.

| Element                                   | Details                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| الْخَمْرُ                                 | the Ma'toof 'Alayh, Marfoo'                                       |
| الْمَيْسِرُ وَالْأَنْصَابُ وَالْأَزْلَامُ | all three are Ma'toof, and all Marfoo'                            |
| The whole Murakkab 'Atfi                  | together it has become the Mubtada, which is Ma'rifah and Marfoo' |
| رِجْسٌ                                    | the Khabar, which is Nakirah and Marfoo'                          |

### 9.2 As the Khabar

هُوَ الْأَوَّلُ وَالْآخِرُ وَالظَّاهِرُ وَالْبَاطِنُ ۚ وَهُوَ بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ عَلِيمٌ

(Surah al-Hadid: 3)

**Translation:** He is the First and the Last, the Manifest and the Hidden, and He is Knowing of all things.

| Element | Details     |
|---------|-------------|
| هُوَ    | the Mubtada |

| Element                                         | Details                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| الْأَوَّلُ وَالْآخِرُ وَالظَّاهِرُ وَالْبَاطِنُ | the whole Murakkab 'Atfi has come in the place of the Khabar, and is therefore Marfoo' |

**A point of rhetoric:** Here the *Khabar* has come as *Ma'rifah* — by the general rule it ought to have been *Nakirah*. The *Khabar* coming as *Ma'rifah* has produced *Hasr* in the sentence, the force of "He alone is". This is the very principle studied in Lectures 35 and 36 under the *Kalimah Hasr*.

## 10. The Tawabi' — the true family of the Murakkab 'Atfi

**Definition:** In grammar there are certain nouns that **take on the l'raab of the noun before them** — that is, they hold no settled l'raab of their own but follow what precedes. These are called the **Tawabi'**, the followers. They are four.

| # | Tabi'         | Definition                           | Example                   |
|---|---------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1 | Sifah or Na't | states the quality of the Mawsuf     | الْكِتَابُ الْجَدِيدُ     |
| 2 | 'Atf          | joined by means of a Harf ul 'Atf    | زَيْدٌ وَعَمْرُو          |
| 3 | Ta'keed       | makes the statement firm             | جَاءَ الْقَوْمُ كُلُّهُمْ |
| 4 | Badal         | stands in the place of what precedes | جَاءَ أَخُوكَ زَيْدٌ      |

**An important point:** The **Murakkab Tawsifi** and the **Murakkab 'Atfi** are both among the **Tawabi'**. That is why both share the principle that "the later word takes on the l'raab of the earlier". The difference is only that in the **Tawsifi** agreement in all four aspects is binding, and in the **'Atfi** only in l'raab.

### The two kinds of 'Atf

The grammarians divide **'atf** further into two kinds.

| Kind       | Definition                                                                                             | Example                                           |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 'Atf Nasaq | that which is made by means of a Harf ul 'Atf — this is the Murakkab 'Atfi, the subject of this lesson | الشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ                             |
| 'Atf Bayan | that which is made without a Harf ul 'Atf, and which explains the noun before it                       | أَبُو حَفْصٍ عُمَرُ<br>(Abu Hafs, that is, 'Umar) |

## 11. Two particular rules for 'Atf upon pronouns

### 11.1 'Atf upon a Majroor pronoun

**Rule:** When the **Ma'toof 'Alayh** is a **Majroor** pronoun, **repeating the Harf ul Jarr is binding with the Ma'toof**.

بِهِ وَزَيْدٍ and not بِهِ وَزَيْدٍ

That is, to say "with him and with Zayd" the *Harf ul Jarr* must be brought upon both.

## 11.2 'Atf upon an attached Marfoo' pronoun

**Rule:** When the *Ma'toof 'Alayh* is an attached *Marfoo'* pronoun, it is **better to bring a separator** before joining anything to it — generally a detached pronoun.

وَقُلْنَا يَا آدَمُ اسْكُنْ أَنْتَ وَزَوْجُكَ الْجَنَّةَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 35)

**Translation:** And We said: O Adam, dwell, you and your wife, in Paradise.

Here a hidden *Marfoo'* pronoun is present within اسْكُنْ. Before coupling زَوْجُكَ to it, the detached pronoun أَنْتَ was brought, which serves as the separator. This is a most refined style of Arabic.

## Summary

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1. The words that join two or more words, constructions or clauses are called the Huroof ul 'Atf, and the whole group a Murakkab 'Atfi.
2. The Murakkab 'Atfi is one kind of the Murakkab Naqis, whose other kinds are the Tawsifi, Isharee, Jarri and Idafi.
3. The Murakkab 'Atfi has three elements: the Ma'toof 'Alayh, the Harf ul 'Atf and the Ma'toof.
4. The word before the Harf ul 'Atf is the Ma'toof 'Alayh and the one after it the Ma'toof.
5. The I'raab of the Ma'toof always accords with that of the Ma'toof 'Alayh; the Ma'toof follows it.
6. All huroof are Mabni, and the Huroof ul 'Atf are among the Huroof Ghayr 'Amilah.
7. They do not themselves change the I'raab of the word after them but give it the I'raab of the word before.
8. The well-known Huroof ul 'Atf are nine: لَا, لَكِنْ, أَوْ, أَمْ, ثُمَّ, وَ, فَ, حَتَّى and حَتَّى.
9. وَ comes where two acts occur together or at once.
10. فَ is for Tarteeb ma' at-Ta'qeeb, the second act following the first at once, without interval.
11. ثُمَّ is for Tarteeb ma' at-Taraakhi, a considerable interval and respite lying between the two acts.
12. In verse 137 of Surah an-Nisa the use of ثُمَّ conveys the long interval between the belief and disbelief of the hypocrites.
13. أَوْ comes for a choice or a doubt, and أَمْ in a question for determining one of two things.
14. أَمْ at the head of a sentence gives "or is it that", and within a sentence the sense of "or".
15. لَكِنْ comes in the Qur'an in two capacities: as a Harf Mushabbah bil Fi'l and as a Harf ul 'Atf.
16. بَلْ turns back from what preceded and sets up a new continuation.
17. حَتَّى comes in the Qur'an mostly as a Harf ul Jarr; as a Harf ul 'Atf its use is the least of all.
18. لَا joins with negation and excludes the Ma'toof from the ruling of the Ma'toof 'Alayh.
19. In a Murakkab 'Atfi agreement of I'raab is binding, while agreement of gender and number is not.
20. الشَّمْسُ is feminine and الْقَمَرُ masculine, yet each was coupled to the other, because both are Marfoo'.
21. 'Atf is always made upon things of like rank: single upon single, construction upon construction, clause upon clause.
22. One Ma'toof 'Alayh may have more than one Ma'toof, as in verse 18 of Surah al-Hajj.
23. The nasb and jarr of the Jam' Salim Mu'annath are alike, so its I'raab is recognised from the Ma'toof joined with it.
24. A Murakkab 'Atfi may become either the Muftada or the Khabar in a Jumla Ismiyyah.
25. In verse 3 of Surah al-Hadid the Khabar coming as Ma'rifah produced the force of Hasr, "He alone is".
26. The Tawabi' are nouns that take on the I'raab of what precedes them: the Sifah, the 'Atf, the Ta'keed and the Badal.

27. The Murakkab Tawsifi and the Murakkab 'Atfi are both Tawabi'; the difference is that the Tawsifi binds all four aspects and the 'Atfi only I'raab.
28. 'Atf is of two kinds: 'Atf Nasaq made by a particle, and 'Atf Bayan made without one, for explanation.
29. When joining to a Majroor pronoun, repeating the Harf ul Jarr is binding.
30. When joining to an attached Marfoo' pronoun, it is better to bring a separator first, as اسْكُنْ أَنْتَ in أَنْتَ وَرَوْجُكَ.

## Exercise

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1. Write both great kinds of the Murakkab and all five kinds of the Murakkab Naqis.
  2. Define the Murakkab 'Atfi and name its three elements.
  3. Why are the Huroof ul 'Atf called Ghayr 'Amilah?
  4. Explain the difference in the working of the Huroof ul Jarrah, the Huroof Mushabbahah bil Fi'l and the Huroof ul 'Atf.
  5. Write the nine Huroof ul 'Atf.
  6. Explain with examples the difference in the use of فُئِمَّ and فُؤِفَ.
  7. Why was فُئِمَّ used in verse 137 of Surah an-Nisa and not فُؤِفَ?
  8. What is the difference between أُمِّ and أَوْ? Give one example of each.
  9. State both senses of أُمِّ and write one Qur'anic example.
  10. In which two capacities does لَكِنْ come in the Qur'an?
  11. Explain the use of حَتَّى and بَلْ with Qur'anic examples.
  12. Which aspects must agree in a Murakkab 'Atfi and which need not?
  13. Which rule is proved by أَلَشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ?
  14. What is the difference in agreement between the Murakkab Tawsifi and the Murakkab 'Atfi?
  15. Write all four levels of 'Atf with examples.
  16. Separate the Ma'toof 'Alayh and all the Ma'toof in verse 18 of Surah al-Hajj.
  17. How is the I'raab of the Jam' Salim Mu'annath recognised?
  18. Give a full analysis of verse 90 of Surah al-Ma'idah.
  19. Why did the Khabar come as Ma'rifah in verse 3 of Surah al-Hadid?
  20. What are the Tawabi'? Name all four.
  21. Explain with examples the difference between 'Atf Nasaq and 'Atf Bayan.
  22. Write both particular rules for 'Atf upon pronouns.
  23. Why was اسْكُنْ أَنْتَ brought in وَرَوْجُكَ الْجَنَّةِ أَنْتَ?
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سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ